

TSE 608000 COMPARATIVE PUBLIC POLICY

Fall 2026

Instructor:	Jonghoon Lee	Email:	jonghoon@gapp.nthu.edu.tw
Time:	Thu 13:20 - 16:20	Place:	CII A9
Credits:	3		

Office Hours: 10:00 - 12:00 on Wednesday, Thursday, and Friday.

Please book the meeting slot via this link: <https://calendar.app.google/YVyEzQC1DmEviKKM7>

Course Description: This course examines how public policies are formulated, adopted, implemented, and evaluated across different political and institutional contexts. Moving beyond a single-country focus, the course takes a comparative perspective on public policymaking in advanced democratic, developing democratic, and authoritarian systems. Students will analyze how political institutions, state capacity, economic structures, interest groups, bureaucracies, and international pressures shape policy outcomes across countries.

The course is organized into three parts. The first part introduces major theories and frameworks of the policy-making process: including institutions, agenda settings, decision-making, implementation, and external pressures. The second part applies these frameworks to substantive policy areas such as welfare states, regulation, industrial policy, globalization, immigration, and emerging technological and environmental challenges. The third part examines comparative policy processes across different political systems and regional contexts, including presidential, parliamentary, and authoritarian regimes, with focused case studies from Taiwan, Korea, Japan, China, Southeast Asia, the United States, and Europe.

The course is designed for students pursuing careers in government, international organizations, business, and research, and aims to develop both analytical and practical policy analysis skills. No advanced quantitative background is required, although students will be introduced to comparative policy research and evidence-based policy analysis throughout the semester.

Course Learning Outcomes: At the conclusion of this course, students should be able to:

- Understand major theories, concepts, and frameworks in comparative public policy and the policy process.
- Analyze key stages of the policy process, including agenda setting, policy formulation, implementation, and evaluation.
- Evaluate how governments respond differently to major policy challenges such as inequality, regulation, globalization, immigration, technological change, and climate governance.
- Apply comparative policy frameworks to real-world cases from East Asia, Southeast Asia, North America, Europe, and other regions.

Course Keywords: Public Policy; Policy-Making Process; Policy Implementation and Evaluation; Comparative Politics; Political Institutions.

Text Books and References:

- The assigned readings are yet to be updated.
- Required readings will be provided by the instructor online.

Evaluation: Participation (10%), Literature Synthesis (20%), Research Workshops (20%), and Thesis-Oriented Research Paper (50%).

- **Participation (10%):** All students are expected to participate actively and thoughtfully in class. Active participation includes asking questions, responding to questions posed by the instructor or other students, and contributing to class discussion in ways that demonstrate careful engagement with the assigned readings. The emphasis is on careful preparation, analytical engagement, and meaningful contribution to the seminar.
- **Literature Synthesis (20%):** The purpose of this assignment is to help students develop the literature review for a master's thesis or thesis-oriented research project. Students will select a broad research topic and identify a week of the course that is substantively relevant to that topic. The topic may be revised later in the semester as the student's interests and research project develop.
 - **Week 4: Topic and Preliminary Reading List (5%)** Students will identify a broad research topic and select approximately 8–12 scholarly works that they plan to use for their literature synthesis assignment. The submission should include: a brief statement defining the research topic or area of interest; a list of approximately 8–12 relevant scholarly works; and a short explanation of why each work was selected and how it appears to be relevant to the chosen topic (1–2 pages).

At this stage, students are not expected to have a fully developed research question, theoretical argument, or contribution. The purpose of the assignment is to identify a promising area of inquiry and begin assembling a relevant body of literature. The topic and reading list are preliminary and may be revised later in the semester as the student's research interests develop.
 - **Selected Week: Literature Synthesis Essay (15%).** Students will submit a literature synthesis (3–5 pages) during the week of the course most closely related to their selected topic. The essay should synthesize, rather than summarize individually, the relevant literature. Students should identify the major questions in the literature, compare competing arguments or theoretical mechanisms, discuss areas of agreement and disagreement, and explain what questions remain unresolved.

Students are not required at this stage to develop their own theoretical argument or identify a definitive research contribution. However, students can use their literature synthesis as a part of their research paper.
- **Research Workshops (20%):** Students will present their developing research projects twice during the semester. The purpose of these workshops is to receive feedback while the project is still being developed.
 - **Week 7: Research Question and Literature (5%):** Students will present their research question, motivating puzzle, significance, relevant literature, and proposed contribution (5 mins).
 - **Week 13: Theory and Research Design (15%).** Students will present their refined argument, theoretical expectations, proposed cases or data, research design, and remaining challenges. Presentations should be **10 minutes** long, followed by **5 minutes** of comments from the assigned discussant. One week before the presentation, the presenter must share an extended draft of their final research paper with the assigned discussant. The purpose of this requirement is to give the discussant enough time to read the project carefully and prepare constructive comments. The presentation should address the following questions:

- * What is the main research question?
- * Why is this question important?
- * What argument or answer does the paper propose?
- * What evidence, cases, data, or research design will be used to support the argument?

The discussant should provide constructive feedback on the presenter's project. Discussant comments should address the clarity and significance of the research question, the strength of the argument, the appropriateness of the research design or evidence, and possible ways to improve the final paper. Discussants are not expected to solve all problems in the project, but they should identify the most important strengths, weaknesses, and next steps for revision.

- **Thesis-Oriented Research Paper (50%):** The major objective of the course is to develop a research project that can serve as the foundation for a master's thesis. Students are strongly encouraged to develop a project related to their anticipated thesis topic. The project will be composed of two stages:
 - **Week 10: Research Prospectus (15%).** Students will submit a 4–5 pages prospectus developing the research question, preliminary literature review, proposed contribution, tentative theoretical argument, and possible cases, data, or evidence.
 - **Week 16: Final Paper Submission (35%).** A thesis-oriented research paper of approximately 12–18 pages, excluding references. The paper should include a clearly stated research question, motivation and contribution, engagement with relevant literature, a theoretical argument, hypotheses or observable implications, and a feasible research design. Students who have already collected relevant evidence may include preliminary empirical analysis, but empirical results are not required.

All submissions should be double-spaced, using 12-point Times New Roman font, and 1-inch margins. References do not count toward the page limit.

- The overall class grade will be the following:

等級制 Letter Grade	A+	A	A-	B+	B	B-	C+	C	C-	D	E	X
百分制分數 Score	100~90	89~85	84~80	79~77	76~73	72~70	69~67	66~63	62~60	59~50	49~1	0
積分 Grade point	4.3	4.0	3.7	3.3	3.0	2.7	2.3	2.0	1.7	1.0	0	0
對應百分制 Percentage Grade	95	87	82	78	75	70	68	65	61	55	49	0

Grading Disputes: If a student wishes to dispute a graded assignment, the student can send the instructor a one-page memo within one week of receiving the graded assignment. The memo should respond to the feedback on the assignment from the instructor. The instructor will carefully review the assignment and its grade, given that the memo provides a reason to do so. After regrading, students must accept the reviewed grade, even if the grade is lower than the original assignment.

Late Work Policy: Late work is defined as any assignment submitted after the established deadline. Work submitted as makeup work for an excused absence is not considered late and is exempt from this policy.

For unexcused late submissions, the assignment grade will be reduced by one letter grade if submitted within one day after the deadline. Work submitted more than one day late will receive an additional one-letter-grade reduction for each additional week it is late.

Attendance Policy: Students are expected to attend class and complete all assignments. Students who are unable to attend class and complete assignments must request leave from the instructor in advance,

except for psychological leave, menstrual leave, and maternity leave.

Leave requests for midterm and final exams are not permitted, except in cases of official duties, illness, childbirth, bereavement, force majeure, or other extenuating circumstances. Such requests must be supported by appropriate documentation and approved by the instructor. Exceptions may be granted at the instructor's discretion.

A late application may be submitted within 7 days of the absence, only in cases of extenuating circumstances, and must be accompanied by the necessary documentation. See [National Tsing Hua University Regulations for Student Leave of Absence](#) for further details.

Rules on the Use of AI: This course adopts a *conditionally open* policy on the use of generative artificial intelligence (AI). Students must clearly specify whether, how, and for what purpose they used AI tools in producing any course output. Students remain fully responsible for the accuracy, originality, integrity, and intellectual quality of all submitted work.

Generative AI tools are **not permitted** for the following assignments or activities: reading assigned articles, preparing weekly reading summaries, serving as discussion leaders, and preparing research presentations. These assignments are designed to evaluate students' own reading comprehension, analytical interpretation, synthesis of scholarly arguments, and ability to lead academic discussion.

Generative AI tools may be used for the **final paper**, but only as a limited research and writing aid. The final paper may not be written entirely or substantially by AI. Acceptable uses may include brainstorming research questions, improving grammar or clarity, organizing an outline, identifying possible weaknesses in an argument, or receiving feedback on draft prose. Students may not present AI-generated text, ideas, citations, data, or analysis as their own original work without proper acknowledgement. Students are also responsible for verifying all claims, citations, quotations, and references, since AI tools may produce inaccurate, fabricated, or misleading information.

When AI tools are used in the final paper beyond minimal spelling, grammar, or formatting assistance, students must include a brief disclosure statement either in a footnote or the acknowledgments section. The disclosure should identify: (1) the name of the AI tool used, (2) the date or approximate period of use, and (3) a concise description of how the tool was used. For example: "I used ChatGPT on March 15, 2026, to receive feedback on the organization and clarity of an early draft. All arguments, evidence, citations, and final wording are my own."

Failure to disclose substantive AI use, use of AI for assignments where it is prohibited, or submission of AI-generated work as one's own may be treated as a violation of the course's academic integrity policy. Please refer to [American Journal of Political Science AI Policy](#) for a useful example of emerging academic norms regarding AI disclosure, human accountability, and limits on AI-generated scholarly work.

Part I. Foundations of Comparative Public Policy

This part introduces the core concepts and theoretical frameworks used to study public policymaking across countries. Students will examine how institutions, agenda-setting, decision-making, implementation, evaluation, interest groups, constituencies, and policy networks shape the policy process. The goal is to build a common analytical foundation for comparing why similar policy problems produce different policy outcomes across political systems.

Week 1. Introduction to Comparative Public Policy

- Required readings:
 - Syllabus

Week 2. Framework and Theory I: Human Nature, Interests, and Ideas

Logistics:

- Required readings:
 - Downs, Anthony. “An Economic Theory of Political Action in a Democracy.” *Journal of Political Economy* 65, no. 2 (1957): 135-150.
 - Simon, Herbert A., 1955. “A Behavioral Model of Rational Choice.” *The Quarterly Journal of Economics*, pp.99-118.
 - Thaler, Richard H. and Sunstein, Cass R., 2021. *Nudge: The Final Edition*. Chapters 1, 3, and 5.
 - BBC: What exactly is “game theory”? <http://www.bbc.com/news/magazine-31503875>
- Suggested further readings:
 - Downs, Anthony, 1957. *An Economic Theory of Democracy*.
 - Simon, Herbert A. 1944. “Decision-Making and Administrative Organization.” *Public Administration Review*, 4(1), pp. 16-30.

Week 3. Framework and Theory II: Institutions

- Required readings:
 - North, Douglass C. 1990. *Institutions, Institutional Change and Economic Performance*. Cambridge University Press: **Part I (pages 1-69)**.
 - Bueno de Mesquita, Bruce, Alastair Smith, Randolph M. Siverson, and James D. Morrow. 2003 *The Logic of Political Survival*. MIT Press: **Chapter 2 (pages 37-75)**.
 - Olson, Mancur. 1993. “Dictatorship, Democracy, and Development.” *American Political Science Review*, 87(3), pp. 567–576.
- Suggested further readings:
 - Lijphart, Arend. 1999. *Patterns of Democracy: Government Forms and Performance in Thirty-Six Countries*. Yale University Press.
 - Tsebelis, George, 2002. *Veto Players: How Political Institutions Work*. Princeton University Press.

- Acemoglu, Daron, and James A. Robinson. 2006. *Economic Origins of Dictatorship and Democracy*. Cambridge University Press.
- Wade, Robert. 1990. *Governing the Market: Economic Theory and the Role of Government in East Asian Industrialization*. Princeton University Press.

Week 4. Agenda Setting and Decision Making

- Logistics:
 - Submit a paper topic and preliminary reading list.
 - Select a submission week for a literature synthesis essay.
- Required readings:
 - Bueno de Mesquita, Ethan. *Political Economy for Public Policy*. Princeton University Press, 2016: **Chapter 2 (pages 51-73)**.
 - Cobb, Roger W., Jennie-Keith Ross, and Marc Howard Ross. 1976. “Agenda Building as a Comparative Political Process.” *American Political Science Review*, 70(1), pp. 126–138.
 - Kingdon, John W. 1984. *Agendas, Alternatives, and Public Policies*. Little, Brown: **Chapter 4 (pages 71-89)**.
 - Rosenfeld, Bryn, and Jeremy Wallace. “Information Politics and Propaganda in Authoritarian Societies.” *Annual Review of Political Science* 27 (2024).
- Suggested further readings:
 - Simon, Herbert A. 1947. *Administrative Behavior: A Study of Decision-Making Processes in Administrative Organization*. Macmillan.
 - Cohen, Michael D., James G. March, and Johan P. Olsen. 1972. “A Garbage Can Model of Organizational Choice.” *Administrative Science Quarterly*, 17(1), pp. 1–25.
 - Downs, Anthony. 1972. “Up and Down with Ecology: The Issue-Attention Cycle.” *The Public Interest*, 28, pp. 38–50.
 - Stone, Deborah A. 1989. “Causal Stories and the Formation of Policy Agendas.” *Political Science Quarterly*, 104(2), pp. 281–300.
 - Baumgartner, Frank R., and Bryan D. Jones. 1993. *Agendas and Instability in American Politics*. University of Chicago Press.
 - Rochefort, David A., and Roger W. Cobb, eds. 1994. *The Politics of Problem Definition: Shaping the Policy Agenda*. University Press of Kansas.

Week 5. Policy Implementation and Evaluation

- Required readings:
 - Lipsky, Michael. 1980. *Street-Level Bureaucracy: Dilemmas of the Individual in Public Services*. Russell Sage Foundation: **Chapters 1-4 (pages 3-53)**.
 - Moe, Terry M. 1984. “The New Economics of Organization.” *American Journal of Political Science*, 28(4), pp. 739–777.
 - McCubbins, Mathew D., Roger G. Noll, and Barry R. Weingast. 1987. “Administrative Procedures as Instruments of Political Control.” *Journal of Law, Economics, and Organization*, 3(2), pp. 243–277.

- Suggested further readings:

- Pressman, Jeffrey L., and Aaron Wildavsky. 1973. *Implementation: How Great Expectations in Washington Are Dashed in Oakland*. University of California Press.
- Miller, Gary J., 2005. “The Political Evolution of Principal-Agent Models.” *Annual Review of Political Science*, 8(1), pp.203-225.
- Kiewiet, D. Roderick, and Mathew D. McCubbins. 1991. *The Logic of Delegation: Congressional Parties and the Appropriations Process*. University of Chicago Press.
- Holmstrom, Bengt. 1979. “Moral Hazard and Observability.” *Bell Journal of Economics*, 10(1), pp. 74–91.
- Bardach, Eugene. 1977. *The Implementation Game: What Happens After a Bill Becomes a Law*. MIT Press.
- Wilson, James Q. 1989. *Bureaucracy: What Government Agencies Do and Why They Do It*. Basic Books.
- Rossi, Peter H., Mark W. Lipsey, and Howard E. Freeman. 2004. *Evaluation: A Systematic Approach*. Sage.

Week 6. Interest Groups, Lobbying, and Policy Feedback

- Required readings:

- Olson, Mancur. 1965. *The Logic of Collective Action: Public Goods and the Theory of Groups*. Harvard University Press: **Chapters 1-2 (pages 5-65)**.
- Lowi, Theodore J. 1964. “American Business, Public Policy, Case-Studies, and Political Theory.” *World Politics*, 16(4), pp. 677–715.
- Hall, Richard L., and Alan V. Deardorff. “Lobbying as Legislative Subsidy.” *American Political Science Review* 100, no. 1 (2006): 69-84.
- Pierson, Paul. 1993. “When Effect Becomes Cause: Policy Feedback and Political Change.” *World Politics*, 45(4), pp. 595–628.

- Suggested further readings:

- Stigler, George J. 1971. “The Theory of Economic Regulation.” *Bell Journal of Economics and Management Science*, 2(1), pp. 3–21.
- Becker, Gary S. 1983. “A Theory of Competition among Pressure Groups for Political Influence.” *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, 98(3), pp. 371–400.
- Haas, Peter M. 1992. “Introduction: Epistemic Communities and International Policy Coordination.” *International Organization*, 46(1), pp. 1–35.
- Mettler, Suzanne. 2005. *Soldiers to Citizens: The G.I. Bill and the Making of the Greatest Generation*. Oxford University Press.
- Grossmann, Matt. 2012. *The Not-So-Special Interests: Interest Groups, Public Representation, and American Governance*. Stanford University Press.

Part II. Policy Processes across Political Systems

This part applies the theoretical tools from Part I to different institutional and regional settings, including presidential systems, parliamentary systems, authoritarian regimes, and developmental states. Students will analyze how separation of powers, cabinet government, party systems, bureaucratic capacity, authoritarian control, and state-business relations affect policy processes and outcomes. The goal is to understand how policymaking differs across regime types and regional contexts.

Week 7. Presidential and Semi-Presidential Systems

- Logistics: Research Workshop I.
- Required readings:
 - Linz, Juan J. 1990. “The Perils of Presidentialism.” *Journal of Democracy*, 1(1), pp. 51–69.
 - Duverger, Maurice. 1980. “A New Political System Model: Semi-Presidential Government.” *European Journal of Political Research*, 8(2), pp. 165–187.
 - Mainwaring, Scott, and Matthew S. Shugart. “Juan Linz, Presidentialism, and Democracy: a Critical Appraisal.” *Comparative Politics* (1997): 449–471.
 - Kasuya, Yuko, ed. 2013. *Presidents, Assemblies and Policy-making in Asia*. Palgrave Macmillan: **Chapters 1, 2, and 6 (pages 1-39 and 134-155)**.
- Suggested further readings:
 - Thompson, Mark R. 2018. “The Philippine Presidency in Southeast Asian Perspective: Imperiled and Imperious Presidents but Not Perilous Presidentialism.” *Contemporary Politics*, 24(3), pp. 325–345.
 - Croissant, Aurel. 2003. “Legislative Powers, Veto Players, and the Emergence of Delegative Democracy: A Comparison of Presidentialism in the Philippines and South Korea.” *Democratization*, 10(3), pp. 68–98.

Week 8. Parliamentary Systems

- Required readings:
 - Strøm, Kaare. 2000. “Delegation and Accountability in Parliamentary Democracies.” *European Journal of Political Research*, 37(3), pp. 261–290.
 - Diermeier, Daniel, and Timothy J. Feddersen. 1998. “Cohesion in Legislatures and the Vote of Confidence Procedure.” *American Political Science Review*, 92(3), pp. 611–621.
 - Huber, John D. 1996. “The Vote of Confidence in Parliamentary Democracies.” *American Political Science Review*, 90(2), pp. 269–282.
 - Martin, Lanny W., and Georg Vanberg. 2004. “Policing the Bargain: Coalition Government and Parliamentary Scrutiny.” *American Journal of Political Science*, 48(1), pp. 13–27.
- Suggested further readings:
 - Ramseyer, J. Mark, and Frances McCall Rosenbluth. 1993. *Japan’s Political Marketplace*. Harvard University Press.
 - Chhibber, Pradeep K., and Irfan Nooruddin. 2004. “Do Party Systems Count? The Number of Parties and Government Performance in the Indian States.” *Comparative Political Studies*, 37(2), pp. 152–187.

- Chhibber, Pradeep K., and Ken Kollman. 2004. *The Formation of National Party Systems: Federalism and Party Competition in Canada, Great Britain, India, and the United States*. Princeton University Press.

Required readings:

Week 9. Non-Democratic and Authoritarian Systems

- Required readings:

- Svolik, Milan W. 2012. *The Politics of Authoritarian Rule*. Cambridge University Press: **Chapters 1, 2, and 4**.
- Heilmann, Sebastian. 2008. “From Local Experiments to National Policy: The Origins of China’s Distinctive Policy Process.” *The China Journal*, 59, pp. 1–30.
- Truex, Rory. 2020. “Authoritarian Gridlock? Understanding Delay in the Chinese Legislative System.” *Comparative Political Studies*, 53(9), pp. 1455–1492.
- Malesky, Edmund, and Paul Schuler. 2010. “Nodding or Needling: Analyzing Delegate Responsiveness in an Authoritarian Parliament.” *American Political Science Review*, 104(3), pp. 482–502.

- Suggested further readings:

- Gandhi, Jennifer, and Adam Przeworski. 2007. “Authoritarian Institutions and the Survival of Autocrats.” *Comparative Political Studies*, 40(11), pp. 1279–1301.
- Magaloni, Beatriz. 2006. *Voting for Autocracy: Hegemonic Party Survival and its Demise in Mexico*. Cambridge University Press.
- Frye, Timothy. 2010. *Building States and Markets After Communism: The Perils of Polarized Democracy*. Cambridge University Press.
- Lorentzen, Peter. 2014. “China’s Strategic Censorship.” *American Journal of Political Science*, 58(2), pp. 402–414.
- Levitsky, Steven, and Lucan A. Way. 2010. *Competitive Authoritarianism: Hybrid Regimes After the Cold War*. Cambridge University Press.

Week 10. Developmental States and Southeast Asia

- Logistics: Submit a research prospectus.

- Required readings:

- Doner, Richard F., Bryan K. Ritchie, and Dan Slater. 2005. “Systemic Vulnerability and the Origins of Developmental States: Northeast and Southeast Asia in Comparative Perspective.” *International Organization*, 59(2), pp. 327–361.
- Huff, W. G. 1995. “The Developmental State, Government, and Singapore’s Economic Development since 1960.” *World Development*, 23(8), pp. 1421–1438.
- Evans, Peter, and James E. Rauch. 1999. “Bureaucracy and Growth: A Cross-National Analysis of the Effects of ‘Weberian’ State Structures on Economic Growth.” *American Sociological Review*, 64(5), pp. 748–765.
- Dell, Melissa, Nathan Lane, and Pablo Querubin. 2018. “The Historical State, Local Collective Action, and Economic Development in Vietnam.” *Econometrica*, 86(6), pp. 2083–2121.

- Suggested further readings:

- Slater, Dan. 2010. *Ordering Power: Contentious Politics and Authoritarian Leviathans in South-east Asia*. Cambridge University Press.
- Haggard, Stephan. 1990. *Pathways from the Periphery: The Politics of Growth in the Newly Industrializing Countries*. Cornell University Press.
- Evans, Peter. 1995. *Embedded Autonomy: States and Industrial Transformation*. Princeton University Press.
- Doner, Richard F. 2009. *The Politics of Uneven Development: Thailand's Economic Growth in Comparative Perspective*. Cambridge University Press.
- Gomez, Edmund Terence, and Jomo K. S. 1999. *Malaysia's Political Economy: Politics, Patronage and Profits*. 2nd ed. Cambridge University Press.

Part III. Comparative Policy Domains and Emerging Challenges

This part turns from institutions and cases to major substantive policy areas, including welfare states and redistribution, markets and regulation, industrial policy, globalization, trade, immigration, climate policy, technology, automation, and artificial intelligence. Students will examine how political institutions, economic structures, social coalitions, and international pressures shape policy choices in these domains. The goal is to develop students' ability to apply comparative policy frameworks to real-world policy debates and emerging governance challenges.

Week 11. Economic Concentration, Automation, and Economic Policy

- Required readings:

- Acemoglu, Daron, and Pascual Restrepo. 2020. “Robots and Jobs: Evidence from US Labor Markets.” *Journal of Political Economy*, 128(6), pp. 2188–2244.
- Autor, David, David Dorn, Lawrence F. Katz, Christina Patterson, and John Van Reenen. 2020. “The Fall of the Labor Share and the Rise of Superstar Firms.” *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, 135(2), pp. 645–709.
- Thewissen, Stefan, and David Rueda. 2019. “Automation and the Welfare State: Technological Change as a Determinant of Redistribution Preferences.” *Comparative Political Studies*, 52(2), pp. 171–208.
- Lee, Jonghoon, and Amy Pond. 2025. “Antitrust and Corporate Taxation.” *Business and Politics*, 27(3), pp. 350–371.

- Suggested further readings:

- Azar, José, Ioana Marinescu, Marshall Steinbaum, and Bledi Taska. 2020. “Concentration in US Labor Markets: Evidence from Online Vacancy Data.” *Labour Economics*, 66.
- Acemoglu, Daron, and Pascual Restrepo. 2019. “Automation and New Tasks: How Technology Displaces and Reinstates Labor.” *Journal of Economic Perspectives*, 33(2), pp. 3–30.
- Kurer, Thomas. 2020. “The Declining Middle: Occupational Change, Social Status, and the Populist Right.” *Comparative Political Studies*, 53(10–11), pp. 1798–1835.
- Im, Zhen Jie, Nonna Mayer, Bruno Palier, and Jan Rovny. 2019. “The ‘Losers of Automation’: A Reservoir of Votes for the Radical Right?” *Research & Politics*, 6(1).
- Humlum, Anders, and Emilie Vestergaard. 2025. “Large Language Models, Small Labor Market Effects.” NBER Working Paper.
- Stigler, George J. 1971. “The Theory of Economic Regulation.” *Bell Journal of Economics and Management Science*, 2(1), pp. 3–21.

Week 12. Capital, Taxation, and Wealth Inequality

- Required readings:

- Saez, Emmanuel, and Gabriel Zucman. 2016. “Wealth Inequality in the United States since 1913: Evidence from Capitalized Income Tax Data.” *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, 131(2), pp. 519–578.
- Hope, David, and Julian Limberg. 2022. “The Economic Consequences of Major Tax Cuts for the Rich.” *Socio-Economic Review*, 20(2), pp. 539–559.

- Kuziemko, Ilyana, Michael I. Norton, Emmanuel Saez, and Stefanie Stantcheva. 2015. “How Elastic Are Preferences for Redistribution? Evidence from Randomized Survey Experiments.” *American Economic Review*, 105(4), pp. 1478–1508.
- Basinger, Scott J., and Mark Hallerberg. 2004. “Remodeling the Competition for Capital: How Domestic Politics Erases the Race to the Bottom.” *American Political Science Review*, 98(2), pp. 261–276.
- Suggested further readings:
 - Piketty, Thomas, and Emmanuel Saez. 2003. “Income Inequality in the United States, 1913–1998.” *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, 118(1), pp. 1–39.
 - Scheve, Kenneth, and David Stasavage. 2016. *Taxing the Rich: A History of Fiscal Fairness in the United States and Europe*. Princeton University Press.
 - Bretschger, Lucas, and Frank Hettich. 2002. “Globalisation, Capital Mobility and Tax Competition: Theory and Evidence for OECD Countries.” *European Journal of Political Economy*, 18(4), pp. 695–716.
 - Zucman, Gabriel. 2013. “The Missing Wealth of Nations: Are Europe and the U.S. Net Debtors or Net Creditors?” *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, 128(3), pp. 1321–1364.
 - Stantcheva, Stefanie. 2021. “Understanding Tax Policy: How Do People Reason?” *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, 136(4), pp. 2309–2369.

Week 13. Student Presentations

- Logistics: Research Workshop II.

Week 14. Gender, Housing, and Demographic Changes.

- Required readings:
 - Kleven, Henrik, Camille Landais, and Gabriel Leite-Mariante. 2025. “The Child Penalty Atlas.” *Review of Economic Studies*, 92(5), pp. 3174–3207.
 - “Do Surging House Prices Discourage Fertility? Global Evidence, 1870–2012.” 2024. *Labour Economics*, 90.
 - Favara, Giovanni, and Jean Imbs. 2015. “Credit Supply and the Price of Housing.” *American Economic Review*, 105(3), pp. 958–992.
 - Barilari, Francesco, Nicola Mastroiocco, and Matteo Paradisi. 2025. “Population Aging, Voting, and Political Agendas.” *European Journal of Political Economy*, 90.
- Suggested further readings:
 - Kleven, Henrik, Camille Landais, Johanna Posch, Andreas Steinhauer, and Josef Zweimüller. 2024. “Do Family Policies Reduce Gender Inequality? Evidence from 60 Years of Policy Experimentation.” *American Economic Journal: Economic Policy*, 16(2), pp. 110–149.
 - Mian, Atif, and Amir Sufi. 2011. “House Prices, Home Equity-Based Borrowing, and the U.S. Household Leverage Crisis.” *American Economic Review*, 101(5), pp. 2132–2156.
 - Jordà, Òscar, Moritz Schularick, and Alan M. Taylor. 2015. “Leveraged Bubbles.” *Journal of Monetary Economics*, 76, pp. S1–S20.
 - Saiz, Albert. 2010. “The Geographic Determinants of Housing Supply.” *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, 125(3), pp. 1253–1296.

- Glaeser, Edward L., Joseph Gyourko, and Raven Saks. 2005. “Why Is Manhattan So Expensive? Regulation and the Rise in Housing Prices.” *Journal of Law and Economics*, 48(2), pp. 331–370.
- Tepe, Markus, and Pieter Vanhuysse. 2009. “Are Aging OECD Welfare States on the Path to Gerontocracy? Evidence from 18 Democracies, 1980–2002.” *Journal of Public Policy*, 29(1), pp. 1–28.

Week 15. Globalization, Trade, and Migration

- Logistics: Share an extended draft of the final research paper with discussants.
- Required readings:
 - Autor, David H., David Dorn, Gordon H. Hanson, and Kaveh Majlesi. 2020. “Importing Political Polarization? The Electoral Consequences of Rising Trade Exposure.” *American Economic Review*, 110(10), pp. 3139–3183.
 - Peters, Margaret E. 2015. “Open Trade, Closed Borders: Immigration in the Era of Globalization.” *World Politics*, 67(1), pp. 114–154.
 - Waldinger, Roger, and Tahseen Shams. 2023. “Cross-Border Politics: Diasporic Mobilization and State Response.” *Annual Review of Sociology*, 49, pp. 401–419.
 - Leblang, David. 2010. “Familiarity Breeds Investment: Diaspora Networks and International Investment.” *American Political Science Review*, 104(3), pp. 584–600.
- Suggested further readings:
 - Alesina, Alberto, and Marco Tabellini. 2024. “The Political Effects of Immigration: Culture or Economics?” *Journal of Economic Literature*, 62(1), pp. 5–46.
 - Wellman, Elizabeth Iams. 2021. “Emigrant Inclusion in Home Country Elections: Theory and Evidence from Sub-Saharan Africa.” *American Political Science Review*, 115(1), pp. 82–96.
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Week 16. Final Paper Submission

- Logistics: Submit a final paper.